magistrate that Hafiz Saeed participated in early indoctrination sessions, visited the men to check in on their training and motivated them to undertake the attacks, adding that every major operation was undertaken only after receiving his approval.[75] Headley identified Sajid Mir, who oversaw all transnational operatives, and two Lashkar commanders known as Abu Al-Qama and Abu Qahafa as three of the handlers on the phone.[76] He also told investigators that every major Lashkar operation is done in coordination with the ISI and that all of the group's major operatives have ISI handlers. His was Major Iqbal, who provided him with money for surveillance trips to India and, Headley believes, funding to Lashkar for the boat that sank during the first attempt in September 2008. Notably, Iqbal often directed Headley to carry out surveillance of other targets and to gather intelligence information unrelated to the Mumbai attacks. Sajid, Headley's Lashkar handler, was the person instructing him to survey the targets struck in November 2008. However, Headley briefed Iqbal on his activities for Lashkar and so the latter was aware of all the targets hit during the attacks.[77] If every major Lashkar member had a handler, as Headley claimed, then it is reasonable to assume others in the ISI were also aware of the operational details. This is reinforced by the fact that at times Headley met with Iqbal to brief him on information, which the latter already had. Western security officials familiar with the case believe a small coterie of serving and retired officers played a role in or had knowledge of the attacks, though that knowledge may not have been uniform.[78] It is also important to reiterate that Headley stated the purpose of Pasha's visit to Lakhvi was to 'understand the Mumbai attack conspiracy.'[79] Pasha had become the Director General of the ISI in late September, after the initial attempted maritime infiltration and two months prior to the attacks. His visit, as Headley describes it, suggests that the ISI leadership was out of the loop, at least with regard to the scope of the plot. If so, this may have resulted from Lashkar's handlers not passing information all the way up the chain of command or from the turnover taking place among the ISI leadership at the time.

Because Headley's testimony provides a useful vehicle for unraveling the attack planning process, it is important to address briefly his own back-story. He was born Daood Gilani and took the name David Headley in 2006 to facilitate his reconnaissance for Lashkar. For the purposes of clarity, this